

year, and next thing you know you're making another New Year's resolution to do something about it. And you're beating yourself up a little more because you can't seem to make any of it stick. Besides, let's be honest, this whole adulting thing, particularly financially adulting, isn't much fun.

So, you stop. Because life's too short.

But what if it didn't have to be that hard? What if it didn't have to be so prescriptive? What if you didn't have to feel like you were walking uphill through inches of thick mud in really bad shoes? Imagine if you could find a system that was tailor-made for you?

My bet is when you think about sorting yourself out financially, you think of budgets. And spreadsheets. And restrictions. Most of us don't love a budget and we really don't love the idea of denying ourselves. Just look at the mantra we're fed constantly by both the media and social media: we're encouraged to seize the day, to enjoy the moment.

Is it any wonder we're doing just that?

But what if I told you that financially adulting isn't about constant deprivation? That the reason you're financially stumbling or even financially sabotaging has nothing to do with your inability to cope with spreadsheets? What if I told you that budgeting doesn't work for the majority of us in the same way that diets don't work, and that budgeting can be harmful to your finances if it doesn't fit with your Money Type? And that the reason there's so much tension about money in your romantic relationship has nothing to do with one of you being a spender and one being a saver and everything to do with your Money Stories?

Now do I have your attention?

I thought so.

I believe that until you understand something I call your 'Financial Phenotype', you'll never find flow with your finances. Money will always be something you battle with and you'll struggle to achieve your financial potential.

What do I mean by Financial Phenotype?

If we head to a Dictionary definition, we can see the term 'phenotype' is used in genetics to describe both 'the observable constitution of an organism' as well as 'the appearance of an organism resulting from the interaction of the genotype and the environment'. In other words,